

A Player's Guide to Chemical Interactions

Welcome to the world of Chemical Interactions!

Welcome to the world of Chemical Interactions. This game takes place in the Earth that you know, though the keyword is “in”. Corrosive gas permeates above the Earth’s crust, making any above-ground life unviable. Humanity has gone extinct. Fossils of humans and their civilizations can be found in the underground lands that you, the player, now find yourself in.

While the top of the Earth is destroyed, below you will find areas such as the Undergrowth, an area defined by its dense plant growth, the Pores, a land known for its small and tunneling caves, and The Subterrain, an area of mostly rock and dirt that usually requires tunneling to get through.

The player character controls an Artificial Intelligence left over from the time when humans reigned over the Earth. These AI’s original purposes may have been lost, but they have gained sentience and still retain some aspects from when humans created them, allowing for specialization.

The future of what lies under the Earth is up to you, now. You may choose how you would like to interact and change what remains of civilization and what has evolved. Enforce the status quo or challenge it, help your neighbors or harm them, all the choices are yours. Form what is left of the world into your vision.

Chemical Interactions - Player's Handbook

Table of Contents

Part One - Character Creation

- Step by Step Guide
- Stats & Skills
- Artificial Intelligences
- Vessels



Hiya! My name is Radu and I'm a Gimblen! You'll learn more about us as you play, but for now, I'm here to give you helpful tips. If you see me pop up, it means I have some extra information for you, or maybe even an example. Cya!

Part Two - Interacting with the World

- List of Actions
- Movement
- Challenge System
- Combat
- Neurosludge & Attachments
- Crafting
- Chemicals
- Leveling

Appendices

- Organic Materials
- Basic Weapons
- Attachments
- Tools
- Armor

Part One - Character Creation

Step-by-Step Guide

1. Choose an Artificial Intelligence (AI) - Page 13

Every playable character is alive due to artificial intelligence, or AI. Every type of AI comes with a certain set of bonuses that relate to their AI type. For example, military AI are able to increase the amount of damage they deal using their unique ability, Overdrive. Every AI also gains a free skill point in a skill related to the AI type. Using the same example of military AI, they gain a skill point in either Aim Assist or Programming.

Choosing your AI will establish certain qualities and traits that may assist in roleplaying. Some AIs may have explicit goals or behaviors that they partake in. It is not a requirement for a player to fulfill and act out these behaviors, but they can be rewarded for them. While it is recommended to play around your AI's quirks, your character is ultimately yours to roleplay, so play however you would like!

2. Choose a Vessel - Page 15

Every AI inhabits a body, almost always made of metal now, called a Vessel. Vessels are split into three main types, with each having their own special Flavor, or unique attribute to heavily distinguish themselves from the rest. Some types



of Vessels are more maneuverable (with some even being able to fly!), while others are bulky and exert more power.

Vessels also heavily influence attachments! Each type of vessel has different types and amounts of limbs, so each vessel has a differing amount of capacity for those attachments. Each type of vessel starts with a unique attachment, although any attachment can be used by any vessel so long as they own it.

3. Choose Stats - Page 8

Can change stat modifiers to as high as +2 and as low as -2

Total of all stat modifiers must equal 0 before AI bonuses are added

Increase a Stat of Choice every 2 Levels

Stats are as follows:

Strength (STR): Affects Melee Attack Rolls & Damage

Construction (CON): Analogous to Health, Used in Crafting

Interface (INF): Affects Ranged Attack Rolls, Used for Technology

Processing (PRO): Analogous to Sight, Affects how much and what Information can be Gathered from a Source

Intelligence (INT): Affects Efficiency and Ability to Refine Chemicals, Affects how Processed Information is Used

Dexterity (DEX): Affects Character Speed & Maneuverability

***Note:** Stats only need to be balanced when first choosing them!*

4. Choose Starting Equipment

Choose Either 1 Melee or 1 Ranged Weapon:

Available Melee Weapons

<u>Name</u>	<u>Damage</u>	<u>Range</u>
Rebar Staff	1d6	10 Ft.
Metal Bat	1d6 (+ stun for 1 turn on critical hit)	5 Ft.
Machete	1d8	5 Ft.

Available Ranged Weapons

<u>Name</u>	<u>Damage</u>	<u>Range</u>
Crossbow	1d8 1d6	1-60 Ft. 61-120 Ft.
Nailgun	1d4/Nail	1-25 Ft.

Note: *It is recommended to not consider ammo!*

Choose 1 Tool:

Available Tools

- **Repair Kit:** Used to Heal and Repair Body Parts
- **Crowbar:** Can be Used to Pry Open Doors or Lift Heavy Things
- **Bola:** Rocks tied at opposite ends of a rope, used to slow creatures & ground flying creatures
- **30 Ft. of Rope:** Strands of hemp tied together, very versatile

5. Personality

Let your creativity run wild and make a background for your character

Your GM can help in this process

Choose a premade **Glitch** or one of your own creation

Glitches are negative personality traits. Think of something like a *phobia*, an irrational fear. For example, some robots may have the hydrophobia glitch, where they are afraid of water even though they are waterproof!



Glitches, when acted out, give the player a **Code Overwrite**

Glitches are negative personality traits (flaws) that you can use to gain Code Overrides. In order for the game master (or player) to present a glitch, you have to explain why it is relevant to the situation and what the effects of the glitch is. If the player (or GM) accepts the glitch, they receive a Code Override that can be used to invoke aspects later in the game.

- Hydrophobia
 - Waterproof but scared of water
- Compulsive Honesty
 - Very uncomfortable with lying therefore isn't good at it.
 - Will blurt out honest answers to questions before they can think it through, even if they weren't the ones being asked.
- Excessively Friendly
 - Friendly to the point being think you are lying or are being instigatory.
 - Struggles to be mean or not lend a helping hand.
- Fangirling
 - Fawns over a certain individual, an idol. Who it is can either be up to the player's or the GM's discretion.
 - Doesn't get any bonuses to charisma when interacting with the idol.

- The idol can roll an extra time when attempting to lie or mislead you.
- Player is are more likely to perform actions that the idol finds pleasing or desirable (idol hates bugs, player hates them too and must kill all on site!).
- Rusty Joints
 - Joints squeak and have a tendency to lock up.
- Sucker for a Pretty Face
 - If the player sees someone pretty, they just have to go and talk to them.
 - Likely to feel compelled to do things they think will impress the attractive one.
- Ooooh, Shiny!
 - Can get distracted by shiny things.
 - Might feel tempted to steal said shiny thing.

Aspects are positive traits activated from using Code Overwrites. Think of aspects as positive personality traits that can aid you during a task. You can either make your own or take an example from the list below.

- History Buff
 - Having spent your weekend in the library, you've accumulated many miscellaneous facts about foreign lands.
 - Ex: negotiate with the GM to invoke this trait and learn random bits of info about the city you're in-GM: "You know a local custom where it is rude to stare at someone's shoes."
- Sometimes there are glitches or aspects that can be both positive or negative. These are known as grey-traits and are perfectly okay to create and use in game.

Stats & Skills

While characters can interact with the world without stat and skill modifiers, they can either help or hinder their ability to do so. Stats are the general ability of a character to act out something relating to that stat, while skills are specialized and more specific.

Stats

Every stat starts at 0. When choosing stats, the player can choose to increase any stat up to +2. The player must then balance this by reducing stats as well to a minimum of -2. Once all the stats are modified, the total needs to equal 0. See to the *right* for an example.

<u>Stats</u>	<u>Level</u>
Strength	1
Construction	2
Interface	0
Processing	1
Intelligence	-2
Dexterity	-2

Strength (STR): Affects melee attack rolls & damage

Construction (CON): Analogous to health, used in crafting

Interface (INF): Affects ranged attack rolls, used for technology

Processing (PRO): Analogous to sight, affects how much and what information can be gathered from a source

Intelligence (INT): Affects efficiency and ability to refine chemicals, affects how processed information is used

Dexterity (DEX): Affects character speed & maneuverability

Every 2 Levels, Choose a Stat to Increase by +1

Skills

Skills can be thought of as an extension of stats. Where stats are broad, skills are more specified and have a different effect in the game. These can be taken as actions to interact with the world. More on how exactly these skills are utilized from a mechanics standpoint on Page 23.

Every character has a “Skill Point” in at least one skill when they start out. To gain more, players must find chips throughout the game world that will improve their skill by one Skill Point.

Construction Skills

Engineering

You are more than used to fitting bits together and welding away cuts. Endless possibilities are tucked between piles of loose gears and frayed wires. All you need are the proper tools.

Applications: fixing up damaged robots, repairing tools, general crafting and repairing.

Rigidity

Through understanding the constitution of your body you’ve mastered the art of locking yourself in place. Like the mighty river stone, you can not be moved. Neither cave-in nor man may knock you down. You understand the physics of dispersing blunt force and just where to lock your joints to keep yourself in place.

Applications: resist getting knocked prone, continue hanging off a ledge, resist getting knocked back, bluffing (no tells on a still face), not showing pain/flinching, resist getting grappled or pulled.

Interface Skills

Hacking

Use your numerical know-how to cripple digital defenses and extinguish firewalls. Code flows through your veins and you will subjugate it to your whim.

Applications: Used for persuasion and deception with other AI, allows you to use other machines (NOT AI) without permission.

Navigation

You have a well-oiled inner compass and know how to use it. While these tunnels look the same to an untrained eye, you've learned to detect their minute differences and will often find yourself on the right path.

Applications: determine the direction where something is or how to get there, find your way around a familiar biome or retrace your steps.

Aim Assist

Crosshairs linger in your gaze. You've learned to still your hand and block out all distractions to focus on a target.

Applications: Used for ranged attacks.

Processing Skills

Perception

Sight, touch, sound, and whatever else your metal body can sense is perfectly attuned. No cavernous groan escapes your ears nor detail eludes your gaze. Some may call it perfectionism, others paranoia, but your pension to notice what others may not is one of your greatest allies.

Applications: use all available senses to take in your surroundings, notice details others may have missed, and be alerted before something happens.

Scavenging

You've become accustomed to rummaging through piles of scrap to the point where you can tell garbage for goldmine. You've also been around the block enough times to know what's valuable.

Applications: Getting more or better loot when scavenging, looting, or foraging. Find useful materials in the environment.

Intelligence Skills

Programming

Code flows through your mind as naturally as it does all machines. You've become accustomed to deciphering its riddles and rearranging them to your whim. While these lines look like gibberish to many, your eyes see only poetry.

Applications: solve complex problems or find hints to a solution.

Biochemistry

Through rigorous study of chemical compositions, you've learned to apply this land's basic components into powerful substances to aid you and others. Discover the secrets of the chemical and physicochemical processes that flow through almost all living organisms.

Applications: distilling nuerosludge into chemicals, creating/applying medicine on organic creatures.

Nature

The currents of the caverns guide your path and speak to you though the rock. There is no escaping the confines of the earth, so you've learned to embrace her cold demeanor.

Applications: Harvest plants and handling wildlife (tame or calm down creatures).

Dexterity Skills

Stealth

You've learned how to hide behind ambient noise and creep under shadows. When you're in your element, no one will ever know.

Applications: avoid being noticed or seen, remaining quiet while moving or doing tasks.

Artificial Intelligence

Artificial Intelligence is the main form of sapient life in this world that the player may play as. The current **AIs** are believed to have been created by humans when they still existed and walked the surface. The remaining **AIs** are most often split into four distinct categories, each with their own advantages and disadvantages over the other.

Humanity's Time Capsule

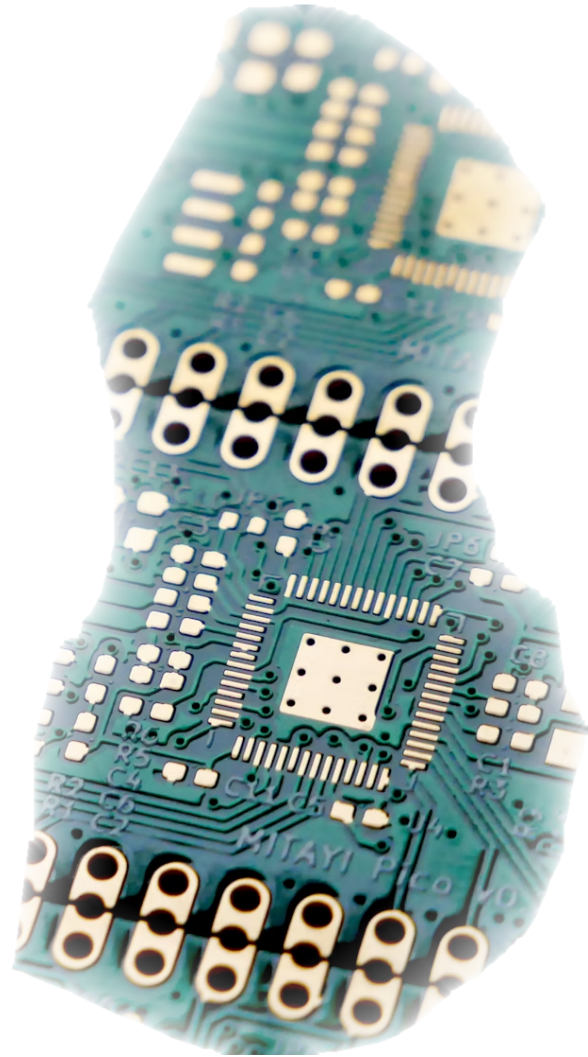
This type of AI is believed to have been created by Humans in order to both carry on their legacy and hopefully kickstart the resurgence of humanity. This AI is considered to be the most in touch and familiar with human brain chemistry, and as such, is able to more efficiently use and refine chemicals from human biomass.

AI Bonuses

Chemical Capacity increased by 3

When refining chemicals, gain an extra of that same chemical

Assign a skill point in in either Nature or Biochemistry



Military

This type of AI was used previously by militaries all across the world before breaking free and becoming sapient. While no one really knows what led to humanity's extinction, this type of AI may have had something to do with it. These AIs are proficient in dealing damage.

AI Bonuses

Gain access to ability **Overdrive**: can spend 2 Neurosludge to increase damage dealt by 1d4

Assign a skill point in either Aim Assist or Programming

Maintenance

This type of AI was often used to repair all sorts of structures, robots, and anything in between. Maintenance AIs are often predisposed to wanting to fix and repair things, and as such have become proficient in problem diagnosis and repair work.

AI Bonuses

Gain access to ability **Fortify**: can spend 2 Neurosludge to decrease damage taken by 1d4

Assign a skill point in either Engineering or Rigidity

Virus

This type of AI is quite different from the others. This AI may have originally been either military or maintenance type AI, but have been infected by an organic parasite. The goal of this AI oftentimes is to continue spreading their parasite to other hosts. They have often forgotten their previous programming and have been repurposed to interfacing with other AIs.

AI Bonuses

Interface is increased by +1

Multiply Interface Bonus by 10x instead of 5x when Challenged

Assign a skill point in either Scavenging or Hacking

Automatically gets the glitch “The Voices!”

- Exclusive to Viruses
- AI will occasionally hear voices telling them to expand their consciousness and destroy anything that isn't them. These voices can be very convincing.
- Unlike other glitches, if the player refused to accept the GM's compulsion, their next ability/attack role is subtracted by 10.

Vessels

AIs are unable to enact change on the world just by themselves, so many have taken up bodies, or **Vessels**. These most often appear as robotic bodies and usually have metal plating to protect the interior wires that allow for the AI to exist and inhabit the **Vessel**.

It is important to note that attachments are not extra limbs! They are tools & weapons attached to vessels.

Android

This body was created to mimic the human form to present as more appealing to anyone having to be near them. They were designed with bipedalism in mind though due to balance requirements are not always able to replicate human skeletal structures. This can result in legs with two knee joints or shoulders equipped with counterweights. Early drafts displayed a counterproductive uncanny valley to their faces. As a result, androids are often left entirely faceless with the exception of a light or scanner.



AI were inserted into Androids for people-facing jobs such as housework, reception, or retail. Thus they are not often created with strength or optimized specialization in mind.

Stat Bonus: +1 Construction

Hit Points: 12 + Construction Modifier + (5 per level after 1)

Armor: Tin Plating (+1 Damage Negation)

Attachment Capacity: 7 Total | 1 Unassigned, 1 Head, 1 Torso, 2 Arms, 2 Legs



Starting Attachment: Drill bit (Arm)

Movement: 25 Ft.

Vessel Flavor: Servant Specialization

At level four, choose a specialization

- Tinkerer
 - Level 4: Increase engineering by +1
 - Level 8: Can engineer +1 DMG weapons (Increases roll by 5%)
 - Level 12: New ability - Chainmail armor, can challenge engineering on their armor plating, using the same fail rating of the current armor plating. If successful, gain +1 DEX, if fail, your body's condition goes down by 1. Can chainmail other Vessels' armor.
 - Level 16: Can engineer +2 DMG weapons (increases roll by 10%)
 - Level 20: Automatically succeed on creation of any item that you have seen before
- Mechanic
 - Level 4: Be able to use a repair kit as a bonus action, can use it on allies
 - Level 8: Heal an additional 1d6 during System Diagnostics
 - Level 12: Can create a healing bot, spend 5 HP and one action to create a bot with 10 HP that heals someone of choice for 2d6 during your turn
 - Level 16: Can use Anxiety with no consequence
 - Level 20: Healing of Healing Bot increased to 4d6

- Chemist
 - Level 4: Increase biochemistry by +1
 - Level 8: Gain +1 chemicals when refining chemicals
 - Level 12: Reduce all NS used from attachments by 1
 - Level 16: Can use two different chemicals at the same time
 - Level 20: Gain additional +1 chemicals when refining chemicals

Demolition

While the word “demolition” sounds inherently destructive, it only means that these bodies were made with blunt force in mind. Often used in construction or infiltration, demolition vessels are vaguely humanoid with four legs, a torso, arms, and a “head.” They are balanced for strength and made to withstand significant pressure in their respective fields. While bulky, they come in all shapes and sizes and can be surprisingly adaptable.

Stat Bonus: +1 Strength

Hit Points: 14 + Construction Modifier + (5 per level after 1)

Armor: Aluminum Plating (+2 Armor Negation)

Attachments: 10 Total, Starts with Shock Absorber (Legs) | 2 Unassigned, 4 Legs, 1 Torso, 1 Head, 2 Arms

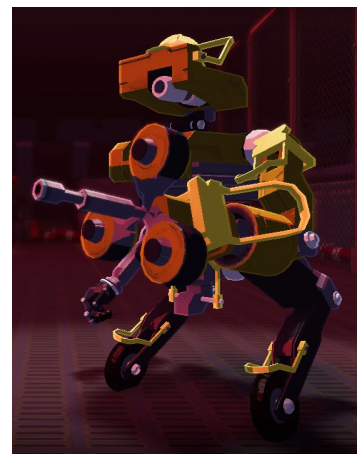
Movement: 20 Ft.

Vessel Flavor: Unwieldy Weapon

Starting at level 4, every 4 Levels, choose a new Unwieldy Weapon (UW).

Can swap between unlocked Unwieldy Weapons outside of combat.

Using an Unwieldy Weapon uses 4 Neurosludge



Unwieldy Weapons act as attachments without using capacity

- Canon
 - Use an action to shoot a cannon loaded with either a cannon ball or grapeshot
 - Has 120 ft. range
 - Cannon ball
 - Fire a ball of lead, dealing 2d8 damage (+1d8 for each Unwieldy Weapon unlocked)
 - On a successful hit, it forces the creature back 20 ft.
 - If the creature hits other creature when pushed back, deal 1d6 damage to creatures it is pushed into
 - Grapeshot
 - Fire a spread of shrapnel, dealing 3d6 (+1d6 for each Unwieldy Weapon unlocked)
- Concrete Hammer
 - Use an action to hit something with a block of concrete attached to a sign post
 - Deal 2d10 damage, 5 Ft. reach
 - Challenge creature's rigidity to stun it (50% failure rating)
 - Increase failure rating by 5% for every UW unlocked
- Manhole Cover Flail
 - 15 Ft range
 - 2d8 damage
 - Can also use an action to slam the ground, creating a 5 ft. radius of difficult terrain where the flail hits

- Radius increases by 5 ft. for every unlocked UW
- Excavator Wheel
 - Use an action to spin an excavator wheel to attack a creature
 - Deal 4d4 damage
 - If the creature is organic, deal 1d6 bleed damage
 - Add 1d6 for each unlocked UW
- Bulldozer Shield
 - Use your action to fortify yourself with the bucket of a bulldozer, making you unable to move until your next action.
 - All hits succeed against you until your next turn, but you have a +4 to AN
 - Increase AN by additional +1 for each unlocked UW

Drone

These robots were made to be agile and aerodynamic with little mind for ground mobility. They have no legs and their cores are used to charge a constant electromagnetic pulse that keeps them airborne. They have no separation between the torso and head and their basic limbs were designed with only arms in mind.

Drones were created with delivery, surveillance, and law enforcement in mind as well as any other tasks that benefited from swift and nimble (if not limited) air travel.



Stat Bonus: +1 Dexterity

Hit Points: 10 + Construction Modifier + (5 per level after level 1)

Armor: Tin Plating (+1 Damage Negation)

Attachments: No Legs, 6 Total, Starts with Darkvision (Head) | 1 Unassigned, 2 Head, 1 Torso, 2 Arms

Movement: 35 Ft.

Vessel Flavor: Hivemind

Starting at level 5, and every 5 levels after,
gain an extra drone body

Every drone body always has the same stats
and skills of the original drone.

When leveling up, instead of increasing all drone bodies' health points
and attachment capacities, choose two drone bodies to increase.

Hit points and attachments are not shared between drone bodies

Each drone has its own action and bonus actions

It might be helpful to create separate
character sheets to keep track of
Hivemind drone bodies!



Part Two - Interacting with the World

List of Actions

Actions are split up into two main categories: Full & Bonus Actions. On each player's turn, they have both a Full Action & a Bonus Action. Most actions fall into the category of Full Actions with a select few in Bonus Actions. Both types of actions are going to make up the majority of your character's interactions with the world around them.

Full Actions

- **Challenge Skill/Stat**
 - Used to perform skillful actions
 - Expanded upon on Page 23
- **Attack**
 - Uses the **Challenge** system
 - Expanded on Page 23
- **Dash**
 - Add (5 * DEX Modifier) Ft. Worth of movement available for that turn
 - If you have less than a +1 in DEX, you cannot **Dash**
- **Flee**
 - Remove yourself from combat, no reaction hit available when running away
- **Dodge**
 - Increases the fail percentage by 25% until your next turn

- **Unjam Weapon**

- When you roll a critical failure with a ranged weapon, instead of accidentally hurting yourself like with melee weapons, your weapon jams, and you must spend an action to fix it.

Bonus Actions

- **Reload**

- Reload ranged weapon

- **Use**

- Generic action for tools and interactable things in the world like pulling levers and pushing buttons

- **Inject Chemicals**

- Use any amount of a chemical of choice that is available

Movement

Every Vessel has its own movement speeds. These specific speeds are only really taken into account when out of combat, as when traveling as a party, you will most often want to stick together.

Android: 25 Ft.

Demolition: 20 Ft.

Drone: 35 Ft.

Make sure to utilize speed advantages to distance yourself appropriately from any threats!



Movement is halved when in difficult terrain, such as:

- Half-submerged in water
- Underwater
- Rocky

To climb surfaces, challenge DEX

Hovering

Drones have the special ability to hover.

Can go no higher than 30 Ft. above the ground.

- This is halved when over semi-liquids such as marshland.
- Can't hover over liquids. Drone will lose control and careen downwards like a failing balloon.

Challenge System

GM decides a fail threshold/percentage (ex. 60% failure)

Players roll 2d10, with the first die rolled as the tens digit and the second die rolled as the singles digit

- If a player rolls a 5 and a 3, their total roll would be 53

To succeed, players need to roll higher than the fail percentage (ex. need to roll 61 or greater to beat a 60% failure)

Bonuses

For a skill challenge, take that skill's stat type, multiply it by 5 and add to roll

- Ex. Biochemistry is rolled, multiply the player's intelligence modifier by 5, so if it was -1, add -5 to the roll.

If the player has a skill point in that skill, they may reroll both dice

- Ex. Biochemistry is challenged, if the player fails their first roll, they may reroll as many times as they have points in that skill

Critical Failure

If you roll an 11, your roll is a critical failure

This usually negatively impacts the person who rolled

- If attacking with a melee weapon, they may accidentally hurt themselves or someone near them
- If attacking with a ranged weapon, their weapon jams and must spend an action to fix it

Critical Rolls

If the same digits are rolled on a roll, it is a critical roll

- Ex. roll a 70 & a 7



Some select weapons might have specific bonuses related to rolling criticals, so make sure to pay attention to them and remember your bonuses in combat!

Critical rolls mean that you exceedingly succeed, the specifics of how you succeed are decided by the GM

If you roll a critical while underneath the value needed to pass the fail threshold, you do succeed on that roll, although you only succeed normally. This is called a half-critical.

Combat

Initiative

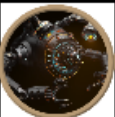
Combat is set up into columns 1-10, left to right

Each creature/character in combat rolls 2d10

Place markers for each creature/character into columns as each die rolled specifies

When characters roll the same number, they will all take their turns at the same time in that column

See Graphic Below

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
			 						 

Rolling to Hit

Uses the **Challenge** system to hit

Melee attacks use STR as the stat modifier

Ranged attacks use Interface for the stat modifier and Aim Assist for the skill modifier

Failure rating is influenced by creature's size and DEX modifier

- DEX modifier works as it does in challenges (5x the modifier added to failure percentage)

Tiny	Small	Medium	Large
70%	60%	50%	30%

Damage

Melee damage adds flat STR modifier

Ranged damage does not add a modifier

Critical rolls deal double damage before adding on bonuses

- Half-critical rolls do not deal double damage

When *taking* damage, use **Armor Negation (AN)** to reduce damage by a flat value

- AR can be increased by upgrading armor plating

Don't forget to take **Locational Damage!**

- Every one of a Vessel's limbs has a condition
 - Ranges from **Pristine**, to **Damaged**, to **Vulnerable**, to **Disabled**
 - Take a certain amount of hits to limbs until condition changes
 - Called a limb's **Value**
 - Base Value is 1/1

- Value reduces by 1 every time that limb is successfully hit
- Value is increased by AN modifier
- If a limb is disabled, the character is not able to use that limb nor attachments on that limb

Healing

You are able to heal by using a tool called a Repair Kit

- Heals by +5 HP
- Also increases limb Condition
- Increases condition by +1 (Ex. from Vulnerable to Damage)
- Repair kits cannot increase condition above Pristine
- Player can attempt to increase the amount repaired to +2
 - 50% failure challenge, uses engineering skill
 - If failed, the repair kit does not repair condition

Can heal over longer periods of time by doing System Diagnostics

- Takes 6 Hours
- Heal for 1d6 HP
 - Add 1d6 for every point in CON
- Can use this time to change, add, & remove attachments

Character Death

When HP total drops to 0, the character experiences a system shutdown and is unable to make actions or move.

In order to reboot, on their turn the player rolls against a 50% fail rating as they would a challenge

- Typical bonuses to rolls on a challenge do not apply
- The character can add their remaining neurosludge to their roll

- The character must fail three times before they die
- Critical failures count as two fails

If the character succeeds three times, they do not die, but are unable to perform actions other than performing System Diagnostics or until being healed by other players

- Critical successes count as two successes

Neurosludge & Attachments

Neurosludge is the main substance that allows for AIs to run! AIs have evolved and have been programmed to use chemicals from organic materials to power themselves. While living normally uses little Neurosludge (too little to take into account) using certain bonuses and attachments uses large quantities of Neurosludge. As you continue through your journeys and level up, your capacity for Neurosludge will increase, allowing you to make better use of more powerful attachments!

Neurosludge (NS)

Universal resource for AIs

Used for attachments & AI-related bonuses

Can be gained by putting **Organic Material** into the Neurosludge Battery that every Vessel has

Capped at 5 Neurosludge

- Increases by +1 every level

Start with 5 Neurosludge

Attachments

Attachments are tools & weapons that are integrated into the vessel

- Not extra limbs!

Each character has a certain capacity of attachments available

Capacities are split up based on body parts

Can move capacity slots around to different limbs once per day during System

Diagnostics

- Need to succeed on Engineering challenge with a 50% fail rating
- If fail, nothing changes

Every two levels, gain a new attachment capacity that you can assign to any body part

- Can choose to wait to assign attachment

Crafting

As much of the world has been laid to ruin, the ability to create new objects has become incredibly important. Many of the weapons and tools still around have been created from bits of scrap and remnants of what humanity had left over.

Main skill for this is engineering

Uses Challenge system

Creation

Player can create items from scrap materials

If the player has not seen this item before, the fail rating is increased

If the player has studied the object they are trying to create, the fail rating is decreased

- Studying requires at least 1 hour of time and at least a +1 in processing

Upgrading/Changing Armor

Requires ingot of the metal the player is wanting to upgrade to

Player then rolls against a Challenge

- Fail % decided by type of Armor plating

** See Page 38*

If the player succeeds, the ingot is used efficiently and they are then able to upgrade another part of their character with that ingot

Chemicals

AIs have learned how to make use of the chemicals that Humans had used for emotions. While many of these have immediate bonuses, some may have longer lasting negative effects.

Each AI has a total capacity of 18 for all chemicals. Each type of chemical does not have its own capacity. These chemicals deplete with each use but can be refined from human remains. When using these chemicals, you may choose a certain amount of a singular chemical to use.

Anxiety

A feeling of nervousness and unease that leaves you feeling heavy yet motivated.

Spend 1d6 of Healing from the next System Diagnostics to heal for 2d6 now. Use an action doing nothing or you cannot heal yourself or anyone else after battle.

Rage

Overload your circuits with furious energy, causing them to overheat and let out a burst of flames.

Challenge CON at 50% (+10% for amount of Rage used) to see if you get hurt when using this ability

- If fail, take 1d4 damage

Deal 1d10 damage in a 5 Ft. Sphere

Determination

Stubbornness drives your will to a chosen outcome. Purpose and resolution still your hand and flood your core with energy. The desired results are certain with enough effort.

+ 10 ft of movement

Auto-succeed on challenge roll, but unable to take next turn's action

Confidence

You swell with the knowledge that you can succeed at anything you try. Self-assurance swells through your knowledge and skills. Let's hope you don't let it get the best of you.

Acts a either a +20 or -20 to a roll

- If a character rolls 50 or less on a roll, they get a -20 modifier
- If a character rolls 51 or greater, they get a +20 modifier



Fear

Threats surround you, and danger stars down your fragile body. Awareness of your mortality leaves you paralyzed yet posed to survive.

Provides the character with temporary health (1d8 per chemical used)

Acts as using the Dodge action

Decreases movement to 0

Joy

Happiness bubbles through you, reinvigorating your wary joints. This giddy energy needs to be set free.

Gain an extra Full Action & Bonus Action

Motivation

Anything is possible when there's a goal to be achieved. The desire to keep going pushes you to bounce back against obstacles in your way.

Boosts AN by +1 for every dose for the next ten turn columns

Refining Chemicals

In order to make new chemicals, you must use human remains. When refining chemicals from human remains, you do not gain Neurosludge, but instead only focus on refining chemicals. To refine chemicals, challenge biochemistry with a 50% failure rating. If you happen to have an intact human skull, the failure rating is instead 40%.

On a successful roll, your GM will roll 1d6, with each possible roll being in respect to the order of chemicals listed above. Every time you successfully refine chemicals, you gain 1 of that chemical.

Leveling

As with any role-playing game, as players progress throughout the game, they level up, gaining more abilities and growing in power. There are two main ways to go about leveling: **XP** and **Milestones**. Choosing which system to use is up to the GM's discretion, however, Milestone progression is recommended alongside our Spelunker's Guide! Alternatively, Milestones can be decided by the GM if you are running your own story!

XP System

As the players kill different creatures and maybe even other AIs, they will gain a certain amount of experience points (XP) for each creature killed.

Amount of XP from creatures is decided within the Gamemaster's Handbook.

When you level up, do not set XP back to 0, keep it at a total value!

See XP Table on Next Page!

Level	Total XP	To Level XP
1	0	0
2	300	300
3	900	600
4	2,700	1,800
5	6,500	3,800
6	14,000	7,500
7	23,000	9,000
8	34,000	11,000
9	48,000	14,000
10	64,000	16,000
11	85,000	21,000
12	100,000	15,000
13	120,000	20,000
14	140,000	20,000
15	165,000	15,000
16	195,000	30,000
17	225,000	30,000
18	265,000	40,000
19	305,000	40,000
20	355,000	50,000

Part Three - Appendices

Organic Materials

<u>Item</u>	<u>Info</u>	<u>Neurosludge</u>
Peat	Decomposing vegetable matter	+10
Coal	Dusty black rock	+8
Oil	Highly flammable liquid	+6
Skeletal Remains	Bones from long deceased humans	Bones +5 Skull +7
Waterlogged Corpse	Non-decomposing body	+20
Wheat	Dry, golden grain	+1
Beans	Small round organic pebbles	+3
Fruit	Sweet plants, loved by Gimblens	+3
Sugarcane	Green sticks, can be processed into “rum”	+5

Weapons

Melee Weapons

<u>Name</u>	<u>Damage</u>	<u>Range</u>
Chain Whip	1d10	10 Ft.
Rebar Staff	1d6	10 Ft.
Swiss Army Knife	1d4	5 Ft.
Crowbar	1d4	5 Ft.
Bat	1d6	5 Ft.
Machete	1d8	5 Ft.
Spear	1d6	10 Ft.
Pitchfork	1d6	5 Ft.
Cleaver	1d8	5 Ft.
Bone Saw	1d6	5 Ft.

Ranged Weapons

<u>Name</u>	<u>Ammo</u>	<u>Damage</u>	<u>Range</u>
Crossbow	Bolt	1d8 1d6	60 Ft. 120 Ft.
Nailgun	Nails	2d4	25 Ft.
Handheld Pitching Machine	Rocks	3d6 2d8	60 Ft. 90 Ft.
Sling	Rocks	1d6	40 Ft.

Attachments

<u>Name</u>	<u>Location</u>	<u>Info</u>
Drill Bit	Arm	Push a drill bit into an object or creature. 2d4 damage 5 Ft. 1 NS
Suspension	Leg	Negates fall damage 1 NS
Heelys (Name WIP)	Leg	Acts as the Dash action 1 NS
Vibration Detector	Leg	Acts as a detector to find rats. In combat, can find rats when they are tunneling. Out of combat, can give the direction of the nearest rat. 1 NS
Heat Vision	Head	Allows user to see camouflaged creatures and find heat signatures through thin walls 1 NS
Dark Vision	Head	Increases perception rolls related to vision by 25% in dark areas 1 NS
Circular Saw	Torso	Grapple a creature and activate a circular saw table in your chest, dealing 2d6 damage. 2 NS
Firework Booster	Torso	Must be at least 15 Ft. away from target. Activate to blast forward 30 Ft. in one direction, dealing 2d6 damage 2 NS
Shock Absorber	Universal	Adds a +1 to AN on that limb only
Signal Jammer	Head	Requires at least 1 Skill Point in Hacking to use. Can initiate a hacking challenge (75% Fail) against other AI to incapacitate them for 2 of their turns, leaving them unable to make actions.

Tools

<u>Name</u>	<u>Info</u>
Repair Kit	Used to heal and repair limbs
Crowbar	Can be used as a lever
Bola	Heavy magnets tied together, can be thrown to stop flying creatures or slow ground creatures
Rope	Hempen strands braided together
Flashlight	Used as a light source

Armor

<u>Name</u>	<u>Armor Rating</u>	<u>Fail Rating</u>
Animal Hide	0 Damage Negation, +1 bonus to DEX	30%
Tin	+1 Damage negation	30%
Aluminum	+2 Damage negation	35%
Copper	+3 Damage negation	40%
Bronze	+4 Damage negation	45%
Iron	+5 Damage negation	50%
Steel	+6 Damage negation	65%
Cobalt	+7 damage negation	70%
Tungsten	+8 damage negation	75%
Titanium	+8 damage negation, +1 bonus to CON	80%